TONY'S UPDATED RT



FULL SIZE



"The world calls it an arc reactor; we call it an RT, which is repulsor technology," explains Property Master Russell Bobbitt, who designs and manufactures Tony Stark's arc reactor—the chest piece that saved his life and powers the Iron Man armor. "It takes about 60 or 70 people to make the arc reactor, and a good six to eight weeks to make it happen.

"In every *Iron Man* movie, Robert comes up with a new motivation to redesign that thing. He'll say something like: 'We're going to take that one triangle we have and break it up into a thousand triangles because I need to break up the molecular structure of the energy so that it's increased by a thousand.' Then he and I sit and work the details out, and then I redraw and rebuild it.

"A lot of craziness goes on inside it just to make it light up. And we have it on a remote control because the battery has such a short life span, since I have such a small piece of real estate to put in electronics and lights. And then we make a new one for each film. And every time I make a new one, I have to make three backups because Robert does stunts and sometimes they get broken. The arc reactor has been a piece of my life for six years now."

Ron Mendell concept art.